



GRAPH DRAWING CONTEST · 2025

NOW PLAYING

Eurovision

A Voting Atlas in Seven Records

33 1/3 RPM · STEREO · LONG PLAY · PRESSED IN EUROPE · 1956–2025

Nº ESC · LP · 2025

52 nations

69 years

2,461 ties



CREATED BY
Kenneth Duff
University of Saskatchewan

THREE QUESTIONS THIS RECORD SET ANSWERS

SIDE A Can we see the voting blocs and who clusters with whom?

SIDE B Which countries consistently vote for or ignore each other?

SIDE C Where does the public consistently disagree with the jury?

A1 COUNTRY BLOC MAP



Geography Is Destiny

The algorithm was told nothing about borders, only who voted for whom. Yet the communities it found in the raw behaviour align almost perfectly with the map of Europe. The Balkans with Balkans, Nordics with Nordics. The maths rediscovered the continent from votes alone. In Eurovision, the song matters less than the neighbourhood.

A2 BLOC-TO-BLOC TIES



The Shape of Alliances

Zoom out and friendships harden into endearing structures. The strongest current runs from Eastern Europe to the far-flung diaspora clusters, while the Baltics and Nordics trade points across their shared sea like family. What binds these regions is not a common sound but a common past. History, not genre, draws these lines.

B1 STRANGERS



Sixty Years of Silence

Some nations have shared the stage for half a century but never traded a single point. These edges show it. Luxembourg and San Marino, Bulgaria and Slovakia: perfect, stubborn zeros. But these zeros can be misleading. Each node is split into the bloc, and the times it competed. A dark node still adrift is a genuine cold shoulder. A light one simply rarely competed.

B2 FRIENDS



Unbreakable Bonds

On the other end, there are countries that seem inseparable. Azerbaijan and Russia exchange points so evenly that it almost seems planned. The Balkan countries vote together as if they are one group, with Montenegro showing more love for Serbia than it gets in return. Some friendships are harder to explain, like those between Australia and Sweden, which are far apart yet among the closest allies in the contest.

C1 THE JURY'S EAR



What the Experts Hear

Since 2016, juries have scored the contest separately from the public, often choosing favourites that the public does not support. Malta is a regular favourite, with juries from Russia, Italy and Austria giving it points that their own viewers do not. The panels focus on craft and composition, but the open question remains whether anyone watching at home hears the same song.

C2 WHERE THEY DISAGREE



A House Divided

Since 2016, out of 1,713 scored relationships, juries and the public have disagreed much more often than they have agreed. Juries chose one side in 884 cases, while the public went the other way in 755. Only about seventy times did they truly agree. In Eurovision, this disagreement isn't a flaw; it is part of the competition's design.

C3 THE PUBLIC'S HEART



The Vote of the Diaspora

The televote depends on individuals, not panels, and people often support countries with which they have close personal or political connections. Ireland favours Poland, Switzerland supports Albania, and Lithuania votes for Russia. These patterns reflect not only migration routes but also diplomatic ties and shared histories. The audience is not judging the performance alone; they are supporting families, communities, and longstanding relationships.

MASTER LEGEND · BLOCS nations

Western Europe	10	Balkans	9
Eastern Europe	8	Southern Europe	6
Nordic	5	Mediterranean	4
Other (AU-CS-MA-YU)	4	Baltic	3
Caucasus	3		

HOW TO READ A VINYL

- ★ ★ ★ Each marker is one country · size ∝ contests entered
- Split node: left half = bloc colour · right half = participation (darker = more contests)
- Line weight ∝ points exchanged per meeting
- Aqua = jury · red = public (C-side)

METHOD & ASSUMPTIONS

Source: Data sourced from EurovisionAPI, covering Grand Finals from 1956 to 2025 (Senior contest only; Junior contest excluded due to lack of country-to-country breakdown).

Blocs: Groups of countries are identified based on observed voting patterns, with each bloc labelled according to its corresponding region. Smaller nations that do not align with a distinct bloc are grouped into miscellaneous categories.

Edge weight represents the average number of points that one country awards to another per shared final, ensuring that infrequently meeting pairs are not penalized.

Node position corresponds to each nation's actual geographic location (i.e., not a force-directed layout); fill colour indicates its assigned regional bloc.

Jury and public votes are distinguishable only from 2016 onward, reflecting the introduction of separate tallies; the three C-side records cover 2016–2025, while all other data spans the competition's full history.

Divergence pairs require at least three shared finals. A "stranger" pair (score 0.0) refers to countries that have never exchanged points.

